

making the effort of accepting calls every time, you can use Open Talk, which enables your PC to accept a call from another PC without you clicking anything.

It is also possible to share files with other users in Yahoo! Messenger. This feature has been enabled from version 8 onwards. Firewalls must be configured so that the transfer is not blocked. Sending is as easy as dragging the file into the IM window. There is no limit on file size. You can share up to 300 photos with each contact. Click on the Photos button at the top of the IM window to share photos with them. You can view the shared photos in a box that expands near the IM window.

If the firewall settings allow, webcams can be used in Yahoo! Messenger. You can also enter public chatrooms, or create your own chatroom and invite friends.

Yahoo! Messenger has loads of plugins available for various purposes. One is Launchcast Radio, which lets you listen to songs in many genres from pop to rock to country to Indian from hundreds of radio stations around the world. Other plugins let you play games, access news and weather information, and get updates from your contacts' blogs. These plugins need to be installed; click on the Add Plug-in button in the Messenger window to install a plugin. Some plugins let you customise the experience when you chat, like the ability to check your calendar and get news feeds.

Yahoo! Messenger interacts with Windows Live Messenger, albeit in a very basic barebones way. You can only do plain chat; features like voice calls, sharing photos, IMVironments, etc. are not supported.

4.2 Multi-protocol IM Clients

This category of software is a boon to people who have IM accounts with different services like Google, Yahoo, and Microsoft. These clients enable you to log in to multiple IM services from the same place. There are both online clients as well as offline clients. Online clients include Meebo; we will only talk about locally-installed software.